# ■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Sunday, August 23, 2026

## TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

## THE LIST (5 stories)

### ■ *Apple's Secretly Revamping That Weird Store Section*

***The Angle:*** *There's a random, oddly-named corner of Apple Stores most shoppers walk right past — and now it's reportedly getting overhauled to launch a whole new device category. Anytime Apple's cooking up something new, the internet turns it into a guessing game.*

- Inside Apple retail stores there's reportedly a lesser-known display area nicknamed the **'Avenues'**
- That section is said to be getting **revamped** to introduce shoppers to a **brand-new type of device**
- The reported overhaul is tied to Apple's rumored push into a new line of **home products**

**The Guessing Game**

- If Apple's building a whole new store section for it, what do you think this mystery home gadget actually is?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Set the Mystery** - 30 seconds -> Host explains Apple is quietly redoing a section of its stores just for one new, unnamed product.
- **Step 2: Callers Guess the Gadget** - 2-3 minutes, phone lines/social -> Ask listeners to call or comment with their wildest guess for what Apple's new home device could be.
- **Step 3: Hosts Make Their Own Bets** - 1 minute -> Each host locks in a guess on-air to revisit once real details leak.

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://gizmodo.com/that-weird-other-section-in-apple-stores-is-reportedly-being-revamped-for-a-new-line-of-home-products-2000802007

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### ■ *Are Trump's tariffs quietly picking your pocket for big business?*

***The Angle:*** *Tariffs were sold as punishment for foreign 'cheaters,' but the money has to come from somewhere — and critics say it's flowing straight from everyday shoppers into the pockets of corporations that know how to work the lobbying game.*

- Tariffs are pitched as making **foreign countries** pay — but the bill often lands on **American consumers** at checkout.
- The system rewards companies that are **adept at playing it**, not necessarily the ones that need the help.
- **Lobbying and political donations** reportedly play a heavy role in who wins exemptions and who doesn't.
- The net effect, per the analysis: wealth moves **up the food chain**, from poor and middle-class Americans to big corporations.

**The Debate Starter**

- Ever notice a price jump and wonder who actually pockets the difference — is it 'protecting American jobs,' or just a hidden tax that ends up in the biggest companies' pockets?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/trump-tariffs-redistribute-wealth-up-food-chain-9.7316144?cmp=rss

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### ■ *Canada could feed the world — so why isn't it?*

***The Angle:*** *Canada's got the farmland and the crops to be a global food superpower, but red tape and broken infrastructure are letting other countries eat our lunch on exports — literally.*

- Experts say **red tape** is one of the biggest things holding back Canada's food exports

- **Infrastructure bottlenecks** — think ports, rail, storage — are choking how much food actually gets out the door
- A **labour shortage** is squeezing the ag sector at the same time
- Meanwhile, **competing countries** are scaling up their own exports and eating into Canada's share

**The Debate Starter**

- We grow enough to feed way more than ourselves — so is this a government failure, or just bad luck?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/canada-food-security-strategy-agrifood-exports-tech-adoption-infrastructure-labour-9.7315712?cmp=rss

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### ■ *Newsom's parole program is springing 'sickos' at 50*

***The Angle:*** *This is a hot-button crime-and-politics story that'll spark real debate — a state parole rule letting older inmates out early is the kind of policy fight that plays everywhere, not just California, especially with a loaded word like 'sickos' driving the outrage.*

- California's **Elderly Parole Program** lets qualifying inmates seek release once they turn **50**
- Inmates must have served at least **20 continuous years** behind bars to be eligible
- Critics tie the program directly to **Gov. Gavin Newsom**, calling it a 'soft parole law'

**The Debate Starter**

- Should age and time served be enough to spring inmates early, or does that let the worst offenders off easy?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/23/us-news/what-is-californias-elderly-offenders-law/

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### ■ *Survivor Says Newsom's Parole System Could Free Her Mentor's Killer*

***The Angle:*** *A first-person survivor account colliding with Gavin Newsom's parole record is a combustible mix of true crime and politics - it turns a policy debate into a personal, emotional gut-punch that listeners will react to.*

- Writer says a **killer** took the life of her **best friend and mentor**
- She was riding in the **rescue vehicle** the day it happened and says she **barely survived**
- She's speaking out publicly because her **colleagues can't**
- She's calling out **Gov. Gavin Newsom's** parole system, warning it could set the killer free

**The Debate Starter**

- Should a governor's parole policy ever be allowed to override what survivors and victims' families want?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://nypost.com/2026/08/23/opinion/meth-impaired-driver-who-killed-two-california-rescue-workers-granted-parole-after-just-22-years/

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## CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

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### ■ *Why are there suddenly so many data centres planned in Canada? Your questions answered*

***The Angle:*** *Why are there suddenly so many data centres planned in Canada? Your questions answered*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/climate/data-centres-ask-faq-9.7316098?cmp=rss

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### ■ *13-year-old hauls in a 711-pound tuna and sets a record*

***The Angle:*** *A kid out-fishing grown adults at a decades-old tournament is an instant feel-good story, and the sheer size of that fish makes it a fun visual for listeners to picture.*

- **Délynn Jacquard**, just **13 years old**, reeled in a **711-pound tuna**
- The catch set a new record at the **22nd annual Wedgeport Tuna Tournament and Festival** in **Nova Scotia**
- Her reaction afterward: **"I didn't think I could do it."**

**The Feel-Good Moment**

- What's the most impressive thing you or your kid has ever pulled off that even you didn't see coming?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/nova-scotia/world-record-tuna-9.7317028?cmp=rss

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### ■ *Freak lightning storm just lit up B.C. and grounded flights*

***The Angle:*** *This isn't your typical Vancouver drizzle - a rare, violent thunderstorm dumped thousands of lightning strikes on the region overnight and threw Vancouver's airport into chaos, which is wild for a city that barely sees thunder a few times a year.*

- **Environment Canada** logged more than **1,800 lightning strikes** over the Lower Mainland Saturday night into Sunday morning
- The **B.C. Wildfire Service** counted over **7,000 strikes** province-wide
- The storm caused disruptions at **Vancouver International Airport**

**The Debate Starter**

- Were you stuck at YVR or did you actually see the lightning show - because B.C. thunderstorms are basically a once-a-summer event.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/southern-bc-thunderstorm-airport-9.7317454?cmp=rss

Backup options:

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### ■ *Japan's Yamashita wins CPKC Women's Open wire to wire in Edmonton*

***The Angle:*** *A dominant start-to-finish win on Canadian soil is the kind of feel-good sports moment that's easy for hosts to riff on, especially with a rising international star notching her second title of the year.*

- **Miyu Yamashita**, 25, of Japan won the **CPKC Women's Open**
- She led **wire to wire** for a dominating performance
- The win happened at **Royal Mayfair Club** in Edmonton
- It's her **fourth LPGA Tour victory** and **second win this year**

**The Quick Take**

- Wire-to-wire wins are rare in golf - ask listeners if they caught any of the final round in Edmonton.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/golf/japan-s-yamashita-captures-cpkc-womens-open-9.7317799?cmp=rss

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### ■■ *Get ready — a 'Godzilla' El Niño is about to shake up our weather*

***The Angle:*** *Scientists say this year's fires and heat waves weren't El Niño's doing — but a supercharged version of the pattern is now kicking in, and it's set to scramble winter weather across Canada just as the planet's already running hot.*

- Experts are calling it a **'super' or 'Godzilla' El Niño** — a major Pacific Ocean warming event.
- It did **NOT** cause this year's fires and heat waves, despite assumptions.
- It's arriving at a time when **many parts of the planet are already overheated**.
- Forecasters are warning of a **'wild ride'** for weather patterns ahead.

**The Debate Starter**

- Callers — noticed your winter already feeling 'off'? Tell us what wild weather you've spotted so far.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/climate/el-nino-2026-extreme-weather-9.7313170?cmp=rss

### ■ *This Quebec town is teaching everyone how to talk to dementia patients*

***The Angle:*** *Dementia touches almost every family, and this is a real, practical fix - not a lab study, an actual town retraining its shop owners, cops and city staff to handle it with patience instead of panic.*

- The initiative is happening in a **Quebec town**, training **local merchants**, **municipal employees** and **emergency responders**
- Goal is to make the community more **"dementia-friendly"** for everyday life - shopping, city services, emergency calls
- Training focuses on helping staff **recognize dementia symptoms** and adapt how they interact with and serve residents living with it

**The Real-Talk Moment**

- Ask listeners: has anyone in your family had a stranger - a cashier, a bus driver - handle a dementia moment with real patience, and did it change how you saw your own town?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/quebec-town-dementia-friendly-9.7313310?cmp=rss

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## ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

### ■ *Brazilian playwright's first-ever film just won Best Picture at Gramado*

***The Angle:*** *It's a full-circle underdog story - a celebrated stage actress and playwright steps behind the camera for the first time and walks away with the top prize at one of Latin America's biggest film festivals.*

- **Grace Passô**'s directorial debut **"Our Secret" ("Nosso segredo")** won the top prize - the **Kikito** for Best Feature Film
- The win came at the closing ceremony of the **54th Gramado Film Festival** on **Aug. 22**
- The film also swept **Best Cinematography** (**Wilssa Esser**) and **Best Art Direction** (**Lucas Osório**)
- Passô is already an established **playwright and actress** - this is her first feature as director

**The Career-Pivot Angle**

- A stage veteran walks into her first-ever film and walks out with Best Picture - who's the most talented person you know who hasn't tried their real shot yet?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/global/passo-nosso-segredo-won-gramado-best-film-kikito-1236841004/

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### ■ *Kingston shows up big for The Hip's last show*

***The Angle:*** *The Tragically Hip are as close to a national institution as Canadian rock gets, and their hometown turning out en masse for the final concert is exactly the kind of shared, feel-good cultural moment that gets listeners reminiscing on air.*

- Crowds packed into **Kingston, Ontario** — **The Tragically Hip's** hometown — to watch the band's final concert.
- CBC describes the scene as a **"celebratory crowd,"** more send-off party than somber farewell.

**The Nostalgia Trigger**

- Ask listeners: what's your go-to Tragically Hip song, and where were you the last time you heard it live?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/livestory/tragically-hip-national-celebration-final-concert-watch-9.7317180?cmp=rss

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### ■■ *Gussapolooza fans toughed out wind and rain to close the fest*

***The Angle:*** *A local music festival wrapped its run despite nasty weather, and the fans stuck it out anyway - easy feel-good fodder about festival-goer dedication.*

**The Debate Starter**

- What's the worst weather you've ever powered through for a concert or festival?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMipgFBVV95cUxNaFZybkQ0UTZuQ21kNVF5bFd1Nm1iQVk0MGVLa0xxS1JOVDRLY0t6aDlyVWVzVEptR3gwVm5JSjBNUjVBNnNwYzRMVnFjeDVzcGVWUTNubC03MENkd2tsdFVpbGRGR3lZRVcyWXBacWFMb2tuNGNBSGd1b2wxVVMyTHlQODh2ejJJd1VvRzhac3dhampEamlETDE5SC01R3JnS3d1RkJn?oc=5

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## ■ *Mark Ruffalo vs. Paramount: 'Antisemitic' Label Sparks Feud*

***The Angle:*** *A Hollywood A-lister just got called antisemitic by his own studio's parent company — and he's not backing down. It's the kind of celebrity-vs-corporation blowup that writes its own headlines.*

- **Mark Ruffalo** publicly accused **David and Larry Ellison** of "powering some of the most destructive and inhuman forces" in a recent statement.
- **Paramount** responded by branding Ruffalo's comments "antisemitic."
- Ruffalo has now fired back at Paramount, escalating the public spat.

**The Debate Starter**

- When does calling out a company's leadership cross the line into something else — and who do you side with here, Ruffalo or Paramount?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/mark-ruffalo-response-paramount-merger-antisemitic-1236840844/

Backup options:

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## ■■ *Turteltaub Confirms It: 'National Treasure 3' Is Happening*

***The Angle:*** *Nic Cage fans have waited almost 20 years for a third heist through American history, and now the director himself is breaking the news live on air - that's a nostalgia bomb worth teasing.*

- Director **Jon Turteltaub** says a third **'National Treasure'** film is officially happening.
- He made the announcement at a **live taping**, saying: **"I have not said anything before this, but you deserve to have the scoop."**
- No cast, plot, or release details confirmed yet - just the green light.

**The Nostalgia Trigger**

- Who's in for 'National Treasure 3' - and what should Nic Cage steal this time?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/national-treasure-3-nicolas-cage-jon-turteltaub-1236840826/

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## ■ *Dr. Dre Says He Uses AI to Produce Songs*

***The Angle:*** *Dr. Dre Says He Uses AI to Produce Songs*

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/dr-dre-says-he-uses-ai-to-produce-songs-2000802009

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## ■ *Foo Fighters Crash the Symphony for Dudamel's Last Bow*

***The Angle:*** *One of the biggest rock bands on Earth teamed up with a world-famous conductor for his farewell show — that's a genuinely wild pairing, and it's a great excuse to talk about when genres collide live.*

- **Foo Fighters** shared the stage with the **LA Phil** at the **Hollywood Bowl**
- It marked famed conductor **Gustavo Dudamel's** final weekend leading the **LA Philharmonic**
- The **LA Phil** has backed pop and rock acts before, but this one reportedly hit different
- Variety called it a full-blown "blow up" of a show, not just a polite orchestral sit-in

**The Debate Starter**

- Rock band plus full orchestra — genius mashup or gimmick? Get the hosts arguing genre-crossover shows that actually worked versus ones that didn't.

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/music/concert-reviews/foo-fighters-hollywood-bowl-gustavo-dudamel-concert-review-1236841090/

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### ■ *Mark Ruffalo Called Out by Jewish Groups Over 'Antisemitic Tropes'*

***The Angle:*** *A movie star with a huge activist following just got a public rebuke from two major Jewish advocacy groups — that's the kind of Hollywood-meets-politics collision that always gets people talking, especially with a studio like Paramount getting dragged into it too.*

- The **Simon Wiesenthal Center** and **Creative Communities For Peace** publicly called out actor **Mark Ruffalo**
- **Jim Berk**, CEO of the Simon Wiesenthal Center, said: **"Words matter, and so does the willingness to draw a line when legitimate debate gives way to antisemitic tropes"**
- The groups praised **Paramount** for "speaking clearly and refusing to allow prejudice to masquerade" as something else
- Ruffalo has not yet issued a public response

**The Debate Starter**

- Where's the line between political criticism and antisemitic rhetoric — and should celebrities be held to a higher standard when they speak out?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/global/mark-ruffalo-paramount-antisemitic-tropes-1236841081/

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## TRENDING TODAY

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### ■ *NYC's Real-Life 'Mole People' Caught Climbing Out of a Manhole*

***The Angle:*** *A viral TikTok video is reviving the decades-old urban legend that people actually live under New York City streets, and this time there's footage - right by one of the busiest spots in Manhattan.*

- Video shows **three men** in **headlamps and overalls** climbing out of a manhole
- Location: **32nd Street and Seventh Avenue**, steps from **Penn Station**
- The clip was posted to **TikTok** and shows them emerging from what's described as the **"steamy depths"** below the street
- The visual instantly plays into NYC's long-running **"mole people"** legend about an underground world beneath the city

**The Phone-In Trigger**

- Ever seen something (or someone) come out of a manhole that made you do a double take - call in with your weirdest only-in-the-city moment.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/23/us-news/new-video-shows-trio-of-mole-people-emerge-from-nyc-manhole-near-penn-station/

Backup options:

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### ■ *90 Day Fiancé's Paula unloads on Thomas on camera*

***The Angle:*** *90 Day Fiancé is one of the biggest reality franchises going, and a blowup insult like this is exactly the kind of clip that goes viral and gets fans picking sides overnight.*

- **Paula** called **Thomas** an **'annoying son of a bitch'** on the show
- She says she's officially **hit her breaking point** with him
- The line is already the moment fans are clipping and sharing from the episode

**The Debate Starter**

- Have you ever had a partner push you to full 'annoying son of a bitch' status?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/23/entertainment/90-day-fiance-paula-brutally-drags-thomas-as-an-annoying-son-of-a-bitch/

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### ■ *Ridley Scott says he's not a director — he's an 'influencer'*

***The Angle:*** *One of Hollywood's most legendary directors just dropped a wild self-description that sounds more like a TikToker than the guy behind Gladiator and Alien — it's a soundbite built for debate.*

- **Ridley Scott** told **The Times of London** he doesn't see himself as a "filmmaker" but as an **"influencer"**
- Asked to name a through line in his work, Scott said: **"Every time, you are vulnerable"**
- He also claimed **"all my films have been on the money"** and that he never wants to repeat himself

**The Debate Starter**

- Is 'influencer' actually the right word for what a legendary director does, or is Ridley Scott just trolling everyone?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/ridley-scott-not-a-filmmaker-im-an-influencer-the-dog-stars-1236841083/

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## LIFESTYLE CHAT

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### ■ *Anti-Aging Pressure Is Hitting Women Younger — And Some Are Done With It*

***The Angle:*** *Anti-aging content has flooded social media, and new research says women are feeling the pressure to look eternally young earlier than ever — but there's a growing pushback worth putting on the table.*

- Researcher **Megan Lindloff** from **London, Ont.** launched the study after noticing anti-aging content "taking over" social media.
- New findings suggest women are feeling pressure to stay "perpetually younger" starting at a **younger age** than in the past.
- Anti-aging products and procedures are described as **"everywhere"** — flooding both feeds and store shelves.
- The research also points to a counter-trend: some women are actively **pushing back** against the anti-aging pressure.

**The Debate Starter**

- How old were you the first time you felt pressure to look 'younger' — and who's calling in to say they've stopped caring?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/london/women-anti-aging-pushback-9.7123105?cmp=rss

Backup options:

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### ■ *Why does a child-killer have online fans now?*

***The Angle:*** *A disturbing corner of the internet is turning Lindsay Clancy — convicted of killing her three kids — into a sympathetic figure, and a NY Post columnist is calling out the trend. It's a jumping-off point for a bigger conversation about true-crime fandom and how far online empathy has gone off the rails.*

- NY Post columnist **Miranda Devine** says a fandom has sprung up around **Lindsay Clancy**, convicted of killing her three children.
- Devine calls it a **"moral rot"** spreading through a small, **"conspiracy-minded, self-engrossed"** cohort online.
- Her argument: this isn't harmless fan culture — it's normalizing an unthinkable act.

**The Debate Starter**

- Where's the line between true-crime fascination and actually defending someone who hurt their own kids?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/23/opinion/miranda-devine-lindsay-clancys-sick-fans-are-just-normalizing-the-horror-of-a-mother-killing-her-three-children/

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### ■■ *ChatGPT Just Got a 'Teen Mode' - But Can Parents Trust It?*

***The Angle:*** *OpenAI is rolling out a teen-specific version of ChatGPT, and it taps right into the anxiety every parent already has about kids and AI chatbots - are these guardrails real protection or just a marketing label?*

- **OpenAI** has introduced a dedicated **ChatGPT for Teens** experience aimed at younger users.
- The launch is fueling the bigger question parents keep asking: can any AI company actually police what a chatbot says to a kid?
- It lands amid mounting pressure on tech companies to prove their safety features for minors hold up in practice.

**The Trust Test**

- Would you let your teen use ChatGPT unsupervised - or does 'built for teens' not mean much to you as a parent?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiswFBVV95cUxOWlpETmhDU2ptYjFUc21OVmFsdlVtazlVUHhxdVVjLVZCdFhSa2RVSHBhR3lmcFNCb1VHR1FueHpkNl9MZHVHZGZGX3NmUFBmcElKODRMWERZbHRtRjVCYjhDVzdkc3RIOFUxSHRncUM5SlRBcnR2RXM3MUwtX1N6OXNOUjA5cjYwcG5OUXllaGJzeVZOY2tiaW5ma1luX2lCWE5NRzlkN0pmbXRlOEZiUEw2VQ?oc=5

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## CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

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### ■ *Man Bitten by Shark in Terrifying Incident Says the Animal Was 'Right' to Have Attacked Him - People.com*

***The Angle:*** *Man Bitten by Shark in Terrifying Incident Says the Animal Was 'Right' to Have Attacked Him - People.com*

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMikAFBVV95cUxNaHgwSlR3RVZVWTdsRzIzNHEwT2dBZTN0OXFzNU0ySnAzcVhWZy10U01LdWRNNkFKYUUtU2pTcDBjVGlhcW9XSjNhdVBabXBacVZTcjJiM05hdkZhUzY2em5lTE56RkhsN1ZZeU50QWlzUEU2eWxoWmV4UVZIQlpUNXp4YW9lXzFEZzlXZjRxS2k?oc=5

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## FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

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## ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

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### ■ *Trump tariffs just wiped out a Manitoba honey farm's customers*

***The Angle:*** *A small family farm in rural Manitoba says U.S. tariffs have cut off the vast majority of their customer base overnight - a real, human-scale look at how the trade fight is landing on Main Street, not just Bay Street or Wall Street.*

- **Osee Podolsky** is general manager of **Podolski Honey Farms** in **Ethelbert, Man.**
- The farm ships the **vast majority** of its honey to customers across the **United States**
- Podolsky says bluntly: **'Effectively, we're out of business'**

**The Debate Starter**

- If a tariff fight thousands of miles away can shut down a small-town Manitoba honey farm overnight, who's actually paying the price for this trade war?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/canada-us-tariff-manitoba-reaction-9.7316905?cmp=rss

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### ■ *They fled the fire, came home to looters*

***The Angle:*** *Wildfire evacuations force whole towns to empty out at once — and this B.C. story is the nightmare scenario that makes every evacuee's stomach drop: what happens to your house while you're gone.*

- **Mira Boucher** says her home in **Summerland, B.C.** was ransacked by looters during a wildfire evacuation.
- Every single house in the community was vacant under the evacuation order — nobody left behind to notice or stop it.
- Boucher describes feeling **'violated'** coming home to find her place broken into.

**The Debate Starter**

- If your town got evacuated tomorrow, would you trust that your house would still be yours when you got back?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/wildfire-evacuation-robbery-summerland-9.7317262?cmp=rss

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### ■ *This $850K Ohio house makes you mow the roof*

***The Angle:*** *It's a real estate listing so weird it broke the internet - an almost entirely underground home with grass growing on top, and agents can't agree if it's a genius bunker or an $850K punchline.*

- The Ohio home is **earth-sheltered**, built almost entirely below ground level
- Listed at **$850,000**
- The roof is covered in grass, meaning owners literally **have to mow the roof**
- Real estate pros are reportedly **scratching their heads** over the price tag

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you pay $850K to live underground, or is this a hard pass no matter how cool the roof looks?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/23/real-estate/earth-sheltered-ohio-home-that-is-built-almost-entirely-underground-comes-with-a-roof-you-have-to-mow/

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### ■ *Liberty limp into the playoffs again — sixth year running*

***The Angle:*** *New York's title defense has been rocky all year, but a Fire loss just punched their playoff ticket anyway - a good excuse to talk about whether a shaky team backing into October still counts as a contender.*

- **New York Liberty** have clinched a playoff spot for the **sixth straight season**
- The berth came courtesy of a **Chicago Fire loss**, not a Liberty win
- Regular season has been described as **shaky** for the defending mindset around the team

**The Debate Starter**

- Does backing into the playoffs off someone else's loss count as 'clinching,' or is that just showing up?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/23/sports/liberty-clinch-playoff-berth-for-sixth-consecutive-season-after-fire-loss/

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## FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)
- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt https://t.co/HwXL2" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)

- "Hayden Panettiere was haunted by crippling back pain from bizarre on-set zebra accident" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-19)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)

- "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: "Disappointed"" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
- "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
- ""Roseanne" Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
- "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal's Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "'Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "Ugly inning, quiet bats doom Yankees in disappointing loss to Blue Jays" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-14)
- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she's sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)
- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to "The Fast and the Furious" 25th Anniversary Screening in LA https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)
- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt 'Disappointed' by BLACKPINK's 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)
- "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite's 'Override' Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)

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## SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/entertainment (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/fauxmoi (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @NYPost (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)

- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- @Variety (fetch failed)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 3 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-23 11:43 PM